

SN 6511 - English Commercial Bank Investment Portfolios, 1860-1914

The main aim of the research was to collect and use previously unused archive data (currently available in the archive repositories of the main commercial banks) to examine policy and practice on the management of investment portfolios by English commercial banks in the decades prior to 1914

The contribution to knowledge arises from the strengthen of our understanding of general asset management by the banks (e.g. their approach to risk; liquidity and capital adequacy) and of the role of financial institutions in the capital market during a period of significant economic and cultural development in both the UK banking sector and secondary capital markets.

The archive data available at the main commercial banks has been used to create datasets. These datasets contain information relating to the investments and securities held by each of the banks for which archive material was available. The data is presented in the form of a series of spreadsheets. A typical spreadsheet details the securities held by a bank in a given year. Further information may be provided such as: the amount held, the price paid, the value, etc. The amount of information provided for a particular bank was dependent upon the amount of information in the surviving archival sources.

The data recorded represents the investments held by 82 English commercial banks over the period from 1860-1914.

The project used the archival material held by the Royal Bank of Scotland Archives Group, Barclays Group Archives, HSBC Group Archives and Lloyds Banking Group Archives. Copyright permissions have been sought and granted.

Table name	Full name of bank	Coverage	Source	Notes
bacon_cobbold.tab	Bacon, Cobbold & Co. Capital & Counties Bank	List of investments 1904	LTSB A/53/63/c/2 file 5041	
bank_liverpool.tab	Bank of Liverpool	Investment Accounts 31 Dec 1879	Barclays 0026/0259	Meaning of column R unclear
bank_westmoreland.tab	Bank of Westmorland	1888-1890	HSBC C016/007	
bank_whitehaven.tab	Bank of Whitehaven	Balance sheet books - Assets - 1871-1914	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives 11247-51	In the column headed 1889, the entries for New South Wales and India appear to be the wrong way around. This is how they are entered in the original text. The same applies for Local Loans and Victoria Government Abbreviations are as in the original text
barclay_beven.tab	Barclay, Beven, Tritton, Ranson, Bouverie & Co	Stock 1865-1897	Barclays 0003/2706	Crystal Palace Rway Bonds & London Crystal Palace may be the same thing sk = stock, stk = stock, shs = shares, bs = bonds, bds = bonds, pref = preference (as written in the original), prefce = preference, deb = debenture, ordy = ordinary meaning of rows 210 and 211 unclear

barnetts_howes_hanbury_lloyd.tab	Barnetts, Howes, Hanbury & Lloyd	Private ledger - Valuation of securities	LTSB A/12/b/1.0-3.0 book 363	
bassett_son_harris_1893_1894.tab	Bassett, Son & Harris (Leighton Buzzard Bank)	List of investments 30 June 1893-94	Barclays 0003/2928	shs = shares
bassett_son_harris_1896.tab	Bassett, Son & Harris (Leighton Buzzard Bank)	Balance sheet 1 July 1896, Investments at values of 1st July 1896	Barclays 0003/2923	
beck.tab	Beck & Co, Shrewsbury	Investments 30 June 1880	LTSB A/10/c/4.0 book 1598	
beckett_1880_1892.tab	Beckett & Co, Leeds	Balance sheet – Assets 1880-1892	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives BEL/164/3	Balance sheets dated on each years 31st December, value in £
beckett_1912.tab	Beckett & Co		The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives BEL/80/10451	
beechings.tab	Beechings & Co	List of stock exchange securities valued for the balance sheet of the 28 October 1890	LTSB A/18/c/3.0 file 5431	Abbreviations as in the original documents
berwick_lechmere.tab	Berwick, Lechmere & Co	Valuation of investments - 15 Jan 1880-90	LTSB A/53/66/b/11.0 book 2213	
birmingham_dudley_district.tab	Birmingham Dudley & District	Investments June 1885-86	Barclays 0003/4814	
birmingham_joint_stock_bank.tab	Birmingham Joint Stock Bank	Investment Account 30 June 1889	LTSB A/15/c/6	
bolitho_williams_1890.tab	Bolitho, Williams, Foster, Coode, Grylls & Co	Valuation of Securities 30th June 1890	Barclays 203/167	Rows 108-110, 112, 194-196, 243-245 and 256 unaccounted
bolitho_williams_1891.tab	Bolitho, Williams, Foster, Coode, Grylls & Co	Valuation of Investments 30 June 1891	Barclays 203/169	
bolitho_williams_1892.tab	Bolitho, Williams, Foster, Coode, Grylls & Co	Valuation of Investments 30 June 1892	Barclays 203/163	
bosanquet_salt.tab	Bosanquet, Salt & Co	Valuation of securities December 1882-83	LTSB A/13/c/4.0 bk 427	Row 27 unaccounted
brighton_union.tab	Hall, Bevan, West & Bevans (Brighton Union Bank)	Balance Sheet 30 September 1891-92, Assets - By investments	Barclays 0003/3272	
carlisle_cumberland_1887.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 30 June 1887	Barclays 0140/0214	Rows 2, 10, 20 and 21 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1888.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 30 June 1888	Barclays 0140/0214	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1889.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as	Barclays 0140/0214	Row 2 unaccounted

		at 30 June 1889		
carlisle_cumberland_1890.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 30 June 1890	Barclays 0140/0214	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1891.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 30 June 1891	Barclays 0140/0214	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1892.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 30 June 1892	Barclays 0140/0214	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1893.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 30 June 1893	Barclays 0140/0214	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1894.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 30 June 1894	Barclays 0140/0214	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1895.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 30 June 1895	Barclays 0140/0214	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1896.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 30 June 1896	Barclays 0140/0214	Rows 2 and 36 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1897.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 31 December 1897	Barclays 0140/0199	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1898.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 31 December 1898	Barclays 0140/0199	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1899.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 31 December 1899	Barclays 0140/0199	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1900.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 31 December 1900	Barclays 0140/0199	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1901.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 31 December 1901	Barclays 0140/0199	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1902.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 31 December 1902	Barclays 0140/0199	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1903.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 31 December 1903	Barclays 0140/0199	Rows 2, 29 and 30 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1904.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 31 December 1904	Barclays 0140/0199	Row 2 unaccounted

carlisle_cumberland_1905.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 31 December 1905	Barclays 0140/0199	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1906.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 31 December 1906	Barclays 0140/0199	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1907.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 31 December 1907	Barclays 0140/0199	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1908.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 31 December 1908	Barclays 0140/0199	Row 2 unaccounted
carlisle_cumberland_1909.tab	Carlisle & Cumberland	The Bank's Reserve and Investments as at 31 December 1909	Barclays 0140/0199	Rows 2 and 38 unaccounted
central_bank_of_london.tab	Central Bank of London	Balance sheets - Assets - 31 December 1876-87	HSBC D044/005	
city_bank.tab	City Bank	Valuation of securities 31 December 1860-67, 1879-85, 1896-97	HSBC E017-19	Abbreviations as in original text
cocks_biddulph.tab	Cocks, Biddulph & Co	Balance sheets 1875-1915	Barclays 230/14&18	Abbreviations as in original text, all values in £
coutts.tab	Coutts & Co	Balance sheets 18 January 1897-1909 - Assets	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives CTT/2	
Cox.tab	Cox & Co	List of investments	1889-90 LTSB A/53/65/b/45.0, 1911-14 LTSB A/56/c/13.0	
croxon_jones.tab	Croxon Jones & Co (Old Bank) Ltd	Balance sheet 31 Dec 1893 - Assets	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives CRO/2	
david_jones.tab	David Jones & Co	Extract from letter from D Jones & Co to Lloyds Bank dated 23 March 1911.	LTSB A/48/c/15.0 file 2607, LTBS A/48/c/11.0 file 2607	Rows C and D unaccounted Note to table: I am preparing a consols a/c since 1906 today, but fear that it will take some time to complete owing to the system of book keeping used by the old firm, where each branch appears to have been treated as a separate bank! I personally had nothing to do with the affairs of the old firm previous to the late autumn of 1905,

				which makes it the more difficult to get at the information, especially as nearly the whole of the staff of the old firm are now dispersed or gone [...]'
				B Davies Evans
davies_banks_1867_1899.tab	Davies, Banks & Co (Kington & Radonshire Bank)	Assets & liabilities - Credit side - 1 July 1867-1899	HSBC R072	Abbreviations as in original text Meaning of the columns CK, CO, CS und CW unklar
davies_banks_1902_1909_1.tab	Davies, Banks & Co	Balance sheets - Assets - 1902-09	HSBC R074	pref = as written in document, deb = as written in document, deb = debenture, mort'ge = as written in document, ins = as written in document
davies_banks_1902_1909_2.tab	Davies, Banks & Co	Balance sheets - Assets - 1902-09, Detailed list of investments available for 1907 & 1909	HSBC R074	pref = as written in document, deb = as written in document, deb = debenture, mort'ge = as written in document, ins = as written in document
deane.tab	Deane & Co, Winchester	Balance sheet 31 December 1890 - Assets	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives DEA/4	
drummond.tab	Drummond, London	Foreign government bonds 2 January 1891	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives DR/211	
east_riding_bank.tab	East Riding Bank	Investments held by East Riding Bank 31 Dec 1919	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives BEL/80/10452	
essex_bank.tab	Essex Bank (Sparrow, Tufnell & Co)	Balance sheet 30 June 1891	Barclays 0003/3518	
exeter.tab	Exeter Bank/Sanders & Co	General balances, 1860-1900 (31 st Dec)	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives SAN/31/1-2	
fordham_gibson_1883.tab	Fordham, Gibson & Co	June 30 1883	Barclays 0003/1008	
fordham_gibson_1884_1886.tab	Fordham, Gibson & Co	June 30 1884 - June 30 1886	Barclays 0003/1008	
fordham_gibson_1887_1889.tab	Fordham, Gibson & Co	30 June 1887 – 31 Dec 1889	Barclays 0003/1008	
fordham_gibson_1890_1891.tab	Fordham, Gibson & Co	June 30 1890 - June 30 1891	Barclays 0003/1008	
fuller_banbury_nix.tab	Fuller, Banbury, Nix & Co, London	Balance sheet 31 December 1894	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives FUL/32	
gloucestershire_banking.tab	Gloucestershire Banking Co	LTSB A/53/77/c/13 file 1762	Dec 31 1885	
goslings_sharpe.tab	Goslings & Sharpe	List of securities held by Messrs Goslings & Sharpe on 1st July 1896	Barclays 0130/0932	Original source contained the sentence “We hereby certify the above to be a true and correct valuation of securities on 1st July 1896”

				Abbreviations as in original text
grant_maddisons_union_1888.tab	Grant & Maddisons Union Banking Co Ltd	Balance sheet: Investments June 30 1888	LTSB A/43/a/3.0 bk 2038	
grant_maddisons_union_1903.tab	Grant & Maddison's Union Banking Co Ltd	Investments taken over from Grant & Maddison's Union Banking Co Ltd, 1903	LTSB A/43/c/5.0 file 2605	
gurneys_1867_1896.tab	Gurney's, Norwich	1867-1896	Barclays 0003/1403-1406	Several unaccounted columns
gurneys_1903_and_1907.tab	Gurney's, Birkbeck, Barclay, Buxton & Orde, Yarmouth	Investments depreciation a/c	Barclays 0003/1289	
hammond.tab	Hammond & Co Bankers, Canterbury, Ramsgate and Whitstable	Balance sheet: Investments 30 June 1903	LTSB A/53/60/c/25 file 7106	
hardcastle_cross.tab	Hardcastle, Cross & Co, Bolton	Balances 25 December 1860-77 - Assets	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives HC/268	
hardy_1859.tab	Hardy & Co	Share of Dividends due to Hardy & Walkington 1859	HSBC AF003/005	
hedges_wells.tab	Hedges, Wells & Co, Oxfordshire	Investments taken over from Messrs Hedges, Wells & Co, 1905	LTSB A/45/c/4.0 file 2604	Abbreviations as in original document
heywood_bros.tab	Heywood Brothers & Co, Manchester	Profit & loss book, Stock & real estate 1860	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives HB/4	Columns D and H unaccounted
hodgkin_barnett_pease.tab	Hodgkin, Barnett, Pease, Spence & Co	Investments 31 December 1902, Investments Taken over from Messrs Hodgkin, Barnett & Co, 1909	LTSB A/42/c/1.0, LTSB A/42/c/4.0 file 2603	Abbreviations as in original document, meaning of column D not clear
hsbc_1885_1888.tab	HSBC Bank	Statement showing the value of the Bank's investments	HSBC AA058	Rows 51-53 unaccounted
hsbc_1890_1896.tab	HSBC Bank	Bank Investments	HSBC AA065	deb = debenture, stk = stock, bds = bonds, guar = guaranteed, Ry = Railway
huddersfield_banking.tab	The Huddersfield Banking Co Ltd	Balance sheets - Assets - December 1880-96	HSBC H015	prefce = preference, as written in original
imperial_bank.tab	Imperial Bank	Balance sheets - 31 December 1862-92	HSBC Q071/002	All sums in £, two numbers for 1865 and 1866
knaresborough_claro.tab	Knaresborough & Claro Banking	Amalgamation papers	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group	Letter to the general managers of National

	Co Ltd	December 1901, Bank's investments account	Archives KNA/1	Provincial Bank 17 December 1902: As desired, I have closely investigated the business of the Knaresbro' & Claro Bank Ltd (commonly known as the Claro Bank) and beg to submit my report herewith. [...]Investments. List enclosed. As you are aware there is a £9350 depreciation, the greater part of it in the two railway ordinary stocks. The investment in this class of security is, in my opinion, the weakest feature I have come across in the executive's management. There has been just one alteration - sale - since last before you. [...] Your obedient servant, Fred Eley. Inspector.
lambton.tab	Lambton & Co	Investments 1907	LTSB A/47/c/3.0 file 6812 - 1907	
leatham_tew.tab	Leatham, Tew & Co	Interest and Dividends 1883 - 1896	Barclays 0003-1040	
leicestershire_banking.tab	Leicestershire Banking Co	Returns to Midland Bank Head Office, Investments 1890 - 1914	HSBC 0217/006	
lincoln_lindsey_banking.tab	Lincoln & Linsey Banking Co Ltd	Balance sheets - Investments & accrued interest, Head Office, 31 December 1911	HSBC 1823/002	Abbreviations as in original document
llandoverly_llandilo_lampter.tab	David Jones & Co, Llandoverly, Llandilo & Lampter	List of investments to be prepared to be dealt with by Lloyds Bank Ltd 1909Bank	LTSB A/48/c/13.0 bk 1323	
lloyds_bank_chief_acc_dept_1900.tab	Lloyds Bank	Lloyds Bank Chief Accountant's Department, 1900	LTSB HO/CA/Inv/1 bk 662	
lloyds_bank_chief_acc_dept_1913_1.tab	Lloyds Bank	Lloyds Chief Accountant's Department, 1913 -1914	LTSB HO/CA/Inv/3/ book 5156	Column C unaccounted
lloyds_bank_chief_acc_dept_1913_2.tab	Lloyds Bank	Lloyds Chief Accountant's Department, 1913 -1914	LTSB HO/CA/Inv/3/ book 5156	
manchester_county.tab	Manchester & County Bank Ltd	Balance sheets 1893-1914 - Assets	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives COU/4	
midland.tab	Midland Bank	Black Books -	HSBC 0532	Abbreviations as in

		Assets - 31 December 1881-1914	1881/88	original text, all figures in £, column AT and rows 771 980-1011 which do not fit into the general strudture of the table unaccounted
national_provincial.tab	National Provincial Bank Ltd, London	Balance sheets - Assets 31 December 1860-81	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives NAT/867	pref'ce = preference, guar'd = guaranteed, consol'd = consolidated, All other abb on originals, all figures in £
north_south_wales.tab	North & South Wales Bank	Investments	HSBC M230	
nottingham_joint_stock.tab	Nottingham Joint Stock Bank Ltd	Balance sheets and profit & loss accounts - 31 December 1888-94	HSBC N030	Abbreviations as on original document, all investments in £
pares_leicestershire_banking.tab	Pare's Leicestershire Banking Co Ltd	Balance sheet 30 June 1896 - Assets	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives PAR/17	
parsons_thomson.tab	Parsons, Thomson & Co, Oxford	Assets - April 1893-99, List of securities with book and market values - 2 July 1900	Barclays 0269/0002, Barclays 0003/2801	Abbreviations as in the original documents, columns M and AP unaccounted
pomfret.tab	Pomfret & Co	Balance sheet listing Sundry Investments	LTSB A/41/c/3.0 file 5448	
prescotts.tab	Prescott's Bank, London	List of investments 30 Sept 1903	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives/131	
samuel_smith_derby.tab	Samuel Smith & Co, Derby	General balances 31 December 1873-1901	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives SSD/27, SSD/70.	
samuel_smith_nottingham.tab	Samuel Smith & Co, Nottingham	General balance - Assets 31 December 1863-81	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives SSN/108	
sheffield_hallamshire.tab	Sheffield & Hallamshire Bank	Assets - Investments - 31 December 1897-1900	HSBC AM004	All figures in £
sheffield_rotherham_js.tab	Sheffield & Rotherham Joint Stock Banking Co Ltd	Valuation of securities held by the bank 31 Decemeber 1870, 1880, 1888, 1891-1906	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives SR/124	Please note that the column headings change over the years GNR = ledger balances grouped together for some Great Northern Ry securities, guar'd = guaranteed, consol'd = consolidated, conv'd = converted, pref'd = preferred, ordy = ordinary, def'd = deferred, pref'l = preferential, red = redeemable All other abbv on original
shrubsole.tab	Shrubsole & Co	Balance sheet prepared in	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group	

		relation to amalgamation 19 May 1894, Assets - Investments	Archives SHR/3	
slocock_matthews.tab	Slocock, Matthews, Southby & Slocock	Investments Account in account with Capital and Counties Bank Ltd 1895	LTSB A/53/36/c/2.0 file 3086	
smith_ellison.tab	Smith, Ellison & Co, Lincoln	Balance sheet - Assets - 31 December 1891-4 then 30 June 1895-1902	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives SEC/29, SEC/92	
stuckeys_banking.tab	Stuckey's Banking Co Ltd	Balance sheet - Assets - 31 December 1878-1908	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives STU/12	
the_channel_islands_bank.tab	The Channel Islands Bank Ltd	List of securities held by the London Joint Stock Bank Ltd on account of the Channel Islands Bank Ltd/Valuation of Investments	HSBC AS006/006-007	Columns B-D and F-H poorly explained in original source
thomas_barnard.tab	Thomas Barnard & Co, Bedford	Balance sheet	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives BAR/1	
tuke_gibson.tab	Tuke & Gibson	Private ledger - 1867-93, May 1867-82, September 1883-90, December 1891-93	Barclays 0003/1117	Abbreviations as in the original text, all figures in £, rows 104, 106, 112 and 113 unaccounted
united_counties.tab	United Counties Bank Ltd	Investments - 31 December 1892-1902, 1904, 1906, 1908	Barclays 000/0013	Abbreviations as in original text, all figures in £, rows 166, 167, 183 and 184 unaccounted
veasey.tab	Veasey, Desborough, Bevan, Tillard & Co (Huntingdon Town & County Bank)	Balance sheet 30 June 1895, Assets - By investments	Barclays 0003/3810	
vivian_kitson.tab	Vivian Kitson & Co	Investments - 6 Jan 1900	LTSB A/34/c/3.0 file 2608	Abbreviations as in original text
wakefield_crewdson.tab	Wakefield, Crewdson & Co	Bankers & investments - 31 December 1883-92	Barclays 0025/0321	Abbreviations as in original text, all figures in £
westminster.tab	Westminster Bank (London County & Westminster Bank Ltd), London	Balance sheets 31 December 1909-14, Assets - Investments	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives WES/1494	
william_deacons.tab	Williams Deacon's Bank Ltd, Manchester	Balance sheets - Assets - 31 December 1890-1914, Valuation of investments	The Royal Bank of Scotland Group Archives WD/387, WD/388	ed = ex div

william_williams.tab	William, Williams & Co, Leeds	Investments in consols, Indian colonial & foreign government securities	LTSB A/38/c/4.0 file 5462	Abbreviations as in original document
willis_percival.tab	Willis, Percival & Co Capital & Countries Bank	List of investments 1868	LTSB A/53/13/b/12 file 2759	
wilts_dorset_banking.tab	Wilts & Dorset Banking Co	Valuation of securities	31 December 1907 - LTSB A/51/b/94, 31 December 1913 - LTSB A/51/c/2.0	Abbreviations as found in original text
woods.tab	Woods & Co (Union Bank, Newcastle Upon Tyne)		Barclays 0003/0069	
yorkshire_penny.tab	Yorkshire Penny Bank	General Balance Sheet 31 December 1910	HSBC 0030/163	